

## Introduction

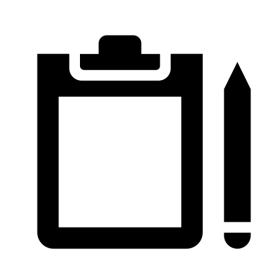
- Burnout has become a global health issue, particularly affecting healthcare workers, with prevalence increasing during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Previous research suggests that higher NFC is associated with lower burnout symptoms and may contribute to resilience against burnout.
- Previous mediation studies (Grass et al., 2018; Zerna et al., 2022) suggest that self-control, emotion regulation, and coping may help explain the relationship between NFC and burnout.
- The present study replicates and extends these models considering all three burnout dimensions.



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## Methods

- **N = 652 healthcare professionals** (e.g., nurses, social workers, psychotherapists, management positions)
- 547 female, 94 male, 1 diverse; M = 38.3 years, SD = 12.0 years)
- Preregistration: <https://osf.io/d6y9k>

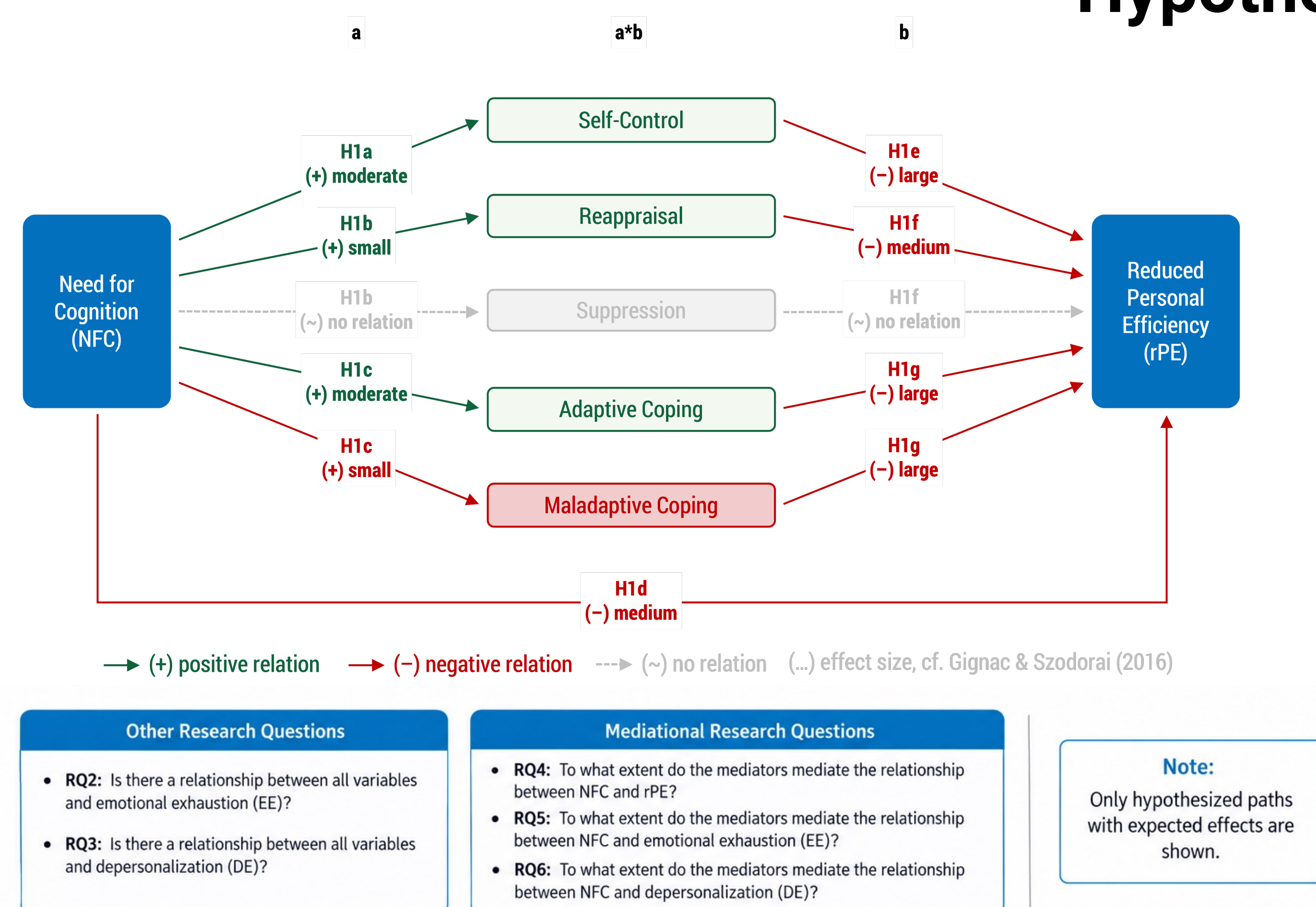


NFC (Bless, 1994); Self-Control (Bertrams & Dickhäuser, 2009); Emotion Regulation (Ablér & Kessler, 2009); Stress and Coping (Satow, 2012), Burnout (Büssing & Perrar, 1992)



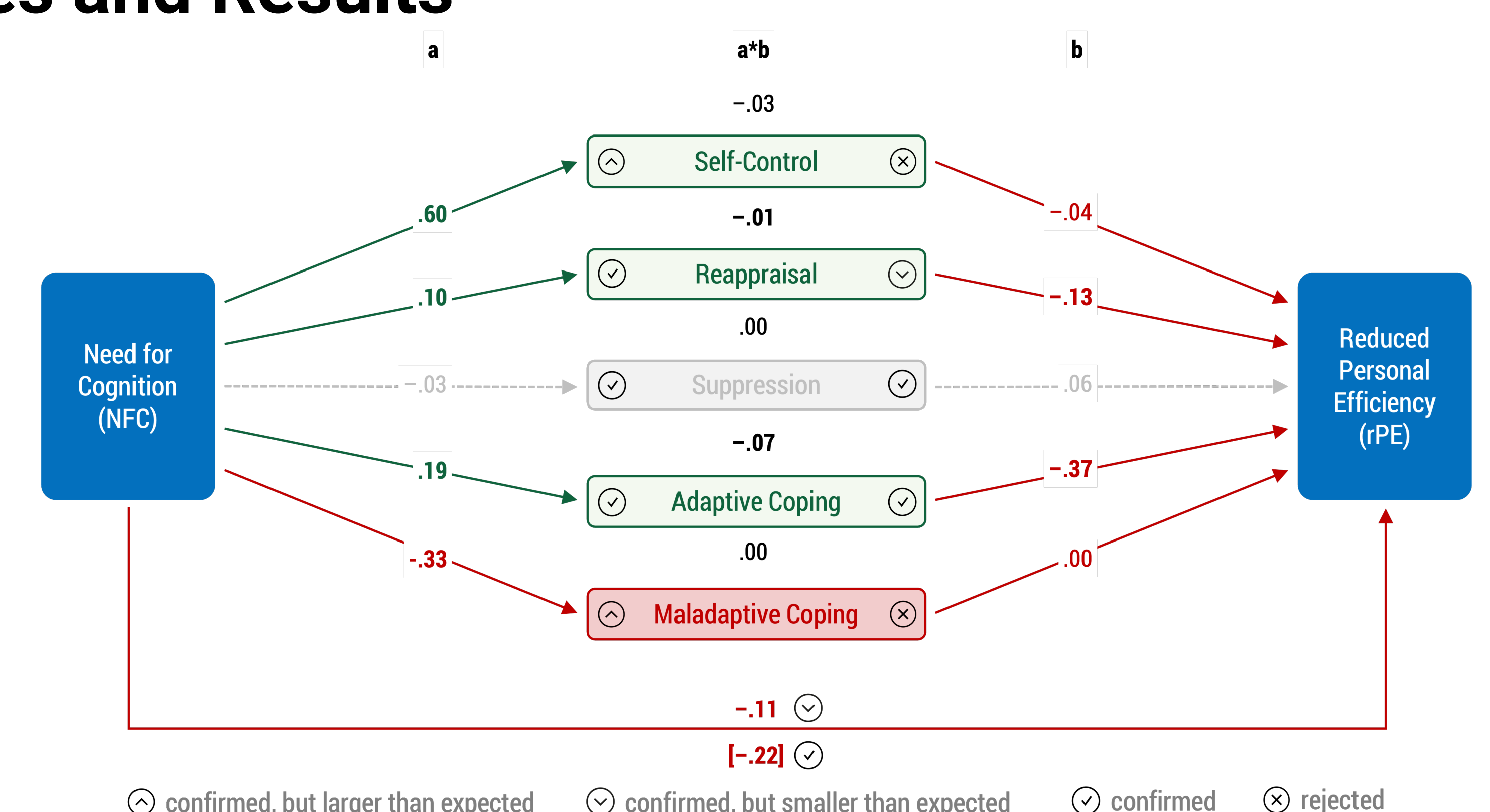
- Bivariate relationships: Spearman correlations; Statistical significance based on correlations' 95% CI not including zero
- Multiple mediation models: lavaan with Maximum Likelihood estimation and bootstrapped standard errors (5,000 bootstrap samples; Inference based on the paths' 95% CI -bias-corrected- not including zero)

## Hypotheses and Results



### Bivariate Relationships concerning NFC:

NFC showed a large positive correlation with self-control ( $r_s = .56$ ) and a large negative correlation with maladaptive coping ( $r_s = -.30$ ). Small positive correlations were found with adaptive coping ( $r_s = .15$ ), whereas small negative correlations emerged for reduced personal efficiency ( $r_s = -.19$ ) and emotional exhaustion ( $r_s = -.18$ ). No meaningful correlations were observed between NFC and reappraisal ( $r_s = .06$ ), suppression ( $r_s = -.01$ ), or depersonalization ( $r_s = -.07$ ).



**Multiple mediation of the relationship between Need for Cognition with the burnout dimension Reduced Personal Efficiency.** Standardized coefficients are given. Indirect paths are provided above the mediators, the remaining direct effect is given at the bottom of the figure together with the total effect (in brackets).

### Emotional exhaustion:

NFC was associated with lower emotional exhaustion, with adaptive and maladaptive coping emerging as significant mediators. No mediation was found via self-control, reappraisal, or suppression.

### Depersonalization:

NFC was associated with lower depersonalization, with effects mediated by both adaptive and maladaptive coping. Self-control, reappraisal, and suppression did not mediate this association.

## Conclusions

- NFC was strongly associated with self-control, with more adaptive, and less maladaptive coping.
- Adaptive coping consistently mediated the association between NFC and all three burnout dimensions, suggesting a key role in the potential protective effect of NFC.
- Promoting adaptive coping may be a promising approach to support well-being and prevent burnout among healthcare professionals.
- Causal conclusions remain limited because of the cross-sectional design.

